

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Ella Gance

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Ella Gance

Collector, Style Patron & Society Fixture

Ella dresses as though the society pages arrive before the guests. Ella has excellent taste, excellent photographers, and excellent instincts about which artists will become impossible to buy next year.

- Collects work by **Vincent Van Faux** and **Elle Loominate**.
- Competes socially and at auction with **Elon Mosaic**.

ACTING TIPS

Charming, strategic, stylish, lightly competitive. Compliments can be sincere and still accomplish something.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Ella Gance. I collect beautiful things and attend beautiful evenings. I am prepared to be disappointed by neither.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Ella Gance

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant knew you quietly sold a work you had publicly promised to donate to another institution and planned to expose the contradiction.

Your other secret

You sold it to cover a failed business investment and hoped to replace it before anyone noticed.

Conversations to start

- Ask Vincent Van Faux what the museum expects a collector to donate.
- Compare gala expectations with Elon Mosaic. Keep your withdrawn donation private for now.

If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings; save corrections for Coming Clean.

Memorize your animal and return the slip. When the host announces the selected animal, use IF MURDERER if it matches yours; otherwise use IF INNOCENT. Never read an IF heading aloud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Ella Gance

The museum has misplaced its paperwork. Naturally.

Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the house. These three hints lead to three different hiding places. Leave the furniture and household objects where they are. Bring an envelope to the Evidence Table; read and share the discovery inside.

- 1 *The keyboard has a secret below middle C, but not among the keys.*
- 2 *Follow the streets of Barcelona with your eyes, then inspect what lies over them.*
- 3 *Find the household's frozen collection. One exhibit is made of paper.*

Already found? Read that discovery at the Evidence Table, then try another hint. Ask for help reaching a hiding place; nobody needs to climb. You may investigate together.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Ella Gance

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Ella Gance

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I sold the work I had promised to another museum. My investment had failed, and promises do not pay an overdraft. I intended to replace it before anyone noticed. Grant noticed first and offered to explain the sale in his speech. He had mistaken an invitation to dinner for permission to discuss my finances.

IF MURDERER

Grant knew I had sold a promised donation to cover a failed investment. I hoped to replace the work before its recipient asked. He planned to reveal the sale tonight. He called it an entertaining example of collecting priorities. I had spent years keeping those priorities much more elegantly concealed.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Ella Gance

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

Where were you before the toast, and why?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

Where did your work take you before the toast?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY



Ella Gance

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I stayed at the style desk for its full mirror interview, 6:49 to 6:55 on the brass overlay. I tried a second lipstick and admitted the sale while the camera ran. The interviewer had asked about generosity. It is difficult to look generous while explaining where the donation went.

IF MURDERER

I stopped at the style desk for a quick photograph, then used a small mirror in the gallery to change my lipstick. Before the toast I was checking whether Grant's speech had reached the lectern. He had seen me in his salon earlier. I wanted to know how much of my sale he intended to make public.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



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Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Ella Gance

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What materials or records passed through your hands?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

Which objects or records need your explanation?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Ella Gance

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

My bag held the buyer's receipt beneath the promised donation's old insurance photograph. The sale paid an overdraft. I could not tell the recipient that without explaining why their gift had become a financial rescue. Grant had obtained a duplicate receipt. I removed his copy from the speech folder and kept it with mine.

IF MURDERER

I kept the buyer's receipt beneath the old insurance photograph and removed Grant's duplicate from his speech folder. He knew what the sale meant. I hoped to buy a replacement before the recipient called. The failed investment had made that plan optimistic. Grant was preparing to give the recipient a reason to call tonight.

The sixteen discoveries and five reports remain at the Evidence Table.



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Ella Gance

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Fold this loose page writing inward and give only the ballot to the host. Keep your packet for Coming Clean. Votes lock when all ballots are collected.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Ella Gance

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. If none confesses, the host calls the selected animal to stand. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I sold the donation and tried to conceal it. The uncut second-lipstick interview keeps me at the mirror desk throughout the corrected contamination interval. I confessed the sale on camera before Grant drank. I shall have to replace the work and repair the promise. I did not poison the person threatening to expose it.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I left the style desk after the photograph. The cloth in my bag carried the conservation toxin to Grant's coupe. I wiped the empty glass and returned to checking his speech. He was going to make my financial collapse a gala anecdote. I made sure he would never reach that paragraph.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.